

Chapter 58-1

The office was silent.

No one understood why Liang Shi had said that. Liang Xinhe frowned and asked, "What do you mean?"

"She'll continue to stoke the fire," Liang Shi said. "The information I'm revealing to her now is that we have no leverage here. That day in the restroom, there were only the three of them, and only Bai Weiwei recorded the video. There's also no surveillance in the restroom, so as long as Bai Weiwei and Chen Liuying coordinate their stories, this matter can be characterized as settled."

Everyone followed her reasoning and understood the logic behind it.

But—

"What's the use of that?" Liang Xinhe said. "Can't we just present evidence directly to deny it?"

"We could, but there's still one person who hasn't come out yet," Liang Shi said. "Chen Liuying, who's been hiding behind Bai Weiwei all this time, is still staying out of it. And if we hammer them directly, this story loses its meaning."

Liang Xinhe: "?"

"What netizens like to see are twists and turns, big satisfying stories, the kind where evidence hits hard," Liang Shi said. Having worked in the entertainment industry for years, she knew better than anyone how deep these waters ran.

Sometimes, not participating directly didn't mean not knowing.

Her agent Sister Wang was a very capable person who had taken her from being unknown to becoming an actress with both popularity and reputation, while also maintaining a good name in the industry herself.

How many people she had dealt with and how many opponents she had played—Liang Shi basically knew it all.

In this circle, you couldn't have malicious intent toward others, but you absolutely had to guard against others' malicious intent toward you.

Sister Wang had always felt that she was too Buddhist¹, like a delicate white flower that couldn't withstand wind, afraid that when she went solo later, she'd be eaten alive without even bones left. So when secretly dealing with opponents and manipulating fan psychology, Sister Wang never avoided letting her see, and even wanted her to learn.

Usually she would just smile without saying anything. Only when Sister Wang lectured her earnestly several times would she retort: "No matter where I go, you'll still be my agent."

"I can't protect you for life," Sister Wang would say. "The roads in this circle are long if you say they're long—some people might walk them their whole lives. But they're also short if you say they're short—make one mistake and there's no way forward. You'd better learn. Those people have all eaten thousand-year ginseng fruit²—they're crafty as monkeys."

What Bai Weiwei had learned in her few years in the industry was far less than what Liang Shi had seen while following Sister Wang.

When Liang Shi said those words, it was as if Sister Wang was whispering earnestly in her ear.

Those forceful words from Sister Wang coming out of her mouth made her feel momentarily dazed.

If Sister Wang could see that she could now stand on her own, becoming the PR strategist for two major companies, she would probably be very gratified.

But there wasn't much time for her to feel sentimental and reminisce.

Liang Shi immediately got into state and explained to everyone: "While I'm revealing this information to Bai Weiwei, I'm also giving her psychological suggestion. With her current twisted psychology and towering hatred, she'll find someone to leak more material. Anyway, mixing truth and lies, her goal is for everyone to curse Xu Qingzhu, then ruin Minghui's reputation."

"This is too troublesome," Liang Xinhe frowned. "Let's just issue a lawyer's letter directly."

"No," Liang Shi said. "This is such a good opportunity. It's trending! Normally this would cost a lot of money."

Liang Xinhe: "...Our family doesn't lack that little bit."

"But using the opponent's money to promote our stuff is never wrong, right?" Liang Shi said. "Save what we can save."

Everyone: "...?"

Liang Shi didn't mind, and instead turned to Sally: "Post another Weibo. I'll send you the copy."

Then she lowered her head to edit the copy: [The previous Weibo was my mistake, sorry. I won't participate in this matter anymore.]

Sally frowned: "This won't work."

"It will," Liang Shi's gentle voice rang out in the office, looking at her with very determined eyes: "Trust me."

With an aura that naturally commanded submission.

Sally reluctantly posted that Weibo, and even added a wronged little expression at the end on her own initiative.

As soon as the Weibo was posted, the comment section was rapidly overrun again.

[So it's true then?]

[Slipping and kneeling this fast—are you afraid we won't buy your designed products?]

[Amazing, the master hits people, the lackey makes snide remarks.]

[Hitting people is definitely confirmed. It's been so long without issuing a lawyer's letter or PR statement.]

[Two major luxury companies! Even if Minghui has fallen, it was once a sun-never-sets empire. Tsk, this is definitely acknowledgment.]

[I'm really speechless. I originally really liked your designs, but now this whole thing has made me lose interest in buying.]

[...]

Sally handed her phone to Liang Shi, helplessly saying: "This place has almost become a garbage dump."

"It's all small stuff," Liang Shi said. "Let the public opinion ferment a bit more."

After Liang Shi finished speaking, she looked at Liang Xinhe: "Second brother, Dongheng's competitors include Changli, right?"

Liang Xinhe raised an eyebrow: "What for?"

Originally thinking that Liang Shi was just fooling around, Liang Xinhe was now gradually becoming interested in what she was doing.

He always felt it should be something big.

Footnotes:

¹ Buddhist: In Chinese internet slang, refers to someone who is very laid-back, non-competitive, and goes with the flow

² Thousand-year ginseng fruit: Reference to the magical fruit from "Journey to the West" that grants immortality; here meaning they're very experienced/cunning